



CHAPLAIN FELLOWSHIP MINISTRIES INTERNATIONAL INC.

CFMI Member's Code of Ethics

Chaplain Fellowship Ministries holds all members accountable for their actions, without accountability there is no credibility.

John 15:16-17

“Ye have not chosen me, but I have chosen you, and ordained you, that ye should go and bring forth fruit, and that your fruit should remain: that whatsoever ye shall ask of the Father in my name, he may give it you. These things I command you that ye love one another.”

As members of Chaplain Fellowship Ministries International, **we are committed to the Christian Ethics of cooperation and professional growth, equality, diversity, human justice and grace.**

We affirm and promote the value, dignity and worth of each person we encounter in the ministry.

In following the model Jesus of Nazareth established for caring for people we covenant to:

Members are ordained and licensed chaplains and ministers called to serve as commissioned by the sacred Word of God.

In Christian grace and duty they respond with love and compassion to people's needs in their whole existence.

We embrace the understanding that human beings are created in the image of God with uniqueness and freedom to think, act and feel.

Code of Conduct

1. Members will not in any way **misrepresent themselves as law enforcement officers, firefighter, federal agents or any other government entity.** We are chaplains!

2. Members understand the high value and dignity of the human being and actively attempt to **avoid allowing their personal needs to exploit others**. Members must always be aware of the power invested in them by their role and by the people seeking help.
3. Members recognize the sacredness of human relationships and **do not engage in sexual intimacies with those coming to them for spiritual support**. Chaplains do not engage in sexual harassment of any kind.
4. Members **will actively attempt to understand and recognize** the diverse cultural backgrounds of the people soliciting or receiving their pastoral care. Members serving as chaplains will not condone or engage in discrimination for any reason.
5. Members will provide pastoral care considering people's own spiritual resources to cope with physical, mental, social, and spiritual challenges.
6. Members must make every effort to **avoid accepting donations or gifts that would knowingly place a hardship on the donor or their family**. Furthermore, members will not accept donations or gifts that would place the donor's welfare, or their families welfare in jeopardy in any way.
7. Members will **take an active role in helping build** Chaplain Fellowship Ministries by recruiting new members for membership thereby assuring the future advancement and stability of the ministry.
8. Members **will not talk down to, degrade, belittle, or disrespect other members** in any way for any reason including but not limited to the following: color, culture, disability, ethnicity, gender, race, religion, education or marital status or for any other reason.
9. Members will **keep their membership current and in good standing at all times**. Members who let their membership expire for a period of 90 days or more will have to submit a new application starting at registered chaplain.
10. Members will renew their membership **on or before their membership renewal date each year**. Membership renewal dates will not be changed for any reason. In the event a member decides to renew at a later date their membership renewal date will remain the same.
11. Members **will not allow themselves to be involved in the following, discrimination, harassment, retaliation, or intimidation** towards other members due to actual or perceived color, culture, disability, ethnic, gender, race, religion, education or marital status or for any other reason.
12. Members will at all times be respectful to each other, the CFMI leadership and the office staff of Chaplain Fellowship Ministries.

(A) Confidentiality and Pastoral Relationship

1. Members serving as chaplains will respect the right of all those that come to them requesting pastoral care. Members serving as chaplains have to control the amount of personal information they want to disclose. Chaplains will respect people's right to privacy and avoid unwarranted disclosures of confidential information.

When appropriate, members must inform those requesting help about the difference between privileged information which may be confidential and threats which may have to be reported. Chaplains must clarify their limits concerning privileged information.

2. Members providing pastoral care to **minors or to individuals who cannot decide for themselves will get the consent from the parents or guardians** by them signing a waiver.
3. Members **will obtain permission** from the people to whom they provide pastoral care before taking notes or electronically recording pastoral encounters.
4. Members **are responsible for securing the safety and confidentiality** of any pastoral encounters and records they create, maintain, transfer, or destroy whether written, recorded, computerized, or stored in any medium.

(B) Chaplain's Competence and Pastoral Relationship

1. Members embrace the need of maintaining high standards of clergy and professional competence in the ministry. Members shall actively strive to grow as disciples of Jesus Christ.
2. Members have a **responsibility to read, understand, and follow the Standards and Code of Ethics** of Chaplain Fellowship Ministries International Inc.
3. Members are committed to continuing their pastoral and personal education to be better equipped to serve.
4. Members **recognize their boundaries of competence** referring to other professionals as they see necessary.
5. Members in teaching positions will use their **pastoral skills and human awareness to uplift** those under their educational care avoiding emotional, physical, social and spiritual harm at all cost.

(C) Procedures for Processing Ethical Violations

Members shall embrace the principle that a ministry comes together not to destroy their members but to build and restore each other.

Therefore, **Chaplain Fellowship Ministries or their members will not engage in activities intended to harm anyone** or pastoral care providers.

Following the biblical counsel, **Chaplain Fellowship Ministries will not entertain any accusation or complaints against our members or elders unless such complaint is brought by two or three reliable witnesses.**

In the event of an unethical violation, Chaplain Fellowship Ministries will follow the process of restoration and redemption as outlined in the Holy Bible.

Agreement

I have **read and agree to abide by the Code of Ethics** of Chaplain Fellowship Ministries International Inc.

I understand agreeing to the Code of Ethics is a condition of membership.

Signature:

Date:

This form must be completed, signed, dated and returned with your application before application for membership can be processed. Please keep a copy for your records.



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